04-17 第一篇

The History of the Compass: How a Simple Tool Changed the World

Before the compass was invented, sailors had to depend on the sun and stars to find their way at sea. When the sky was cloudy, they could easily get lost. [1] The compass changed all that. It uses a needle that always points north, so sailors could find their direction even on dark or foggy days. This small tool, first made in ancient China more than 2,000 years ago, opened up a new age of exploration and trade across the oceans.

The early compass was not like the one we use today. At first, Chinese people used a spoon-shaped piece of a natural mineral called lodestone（天然磁石） that could point north when placed on a smooth surface. [2] Over time, they learned to make a thin needle out of iron and rub it with the lodestone. The needle would then keep pointing north for a while. This made the compass lighter, easier to carry, and more accurate. Sailors could finally take it on long journeys.

The compass spread slowly from China to other parts of the world. Arab traders brought it to the West through the Silk Road. [3] By the 1200s, European sailors had started to use the compass on their ships. It helped them sail farther from shore without losing their way. The discovery of new lands, like the Americas, might not have happened without this tool. The compass truly connected different parts of the world.

Today we have GPS and digital maps. [4] Yet the compass is still used by hikers, sailors, and pilots as a backup when technology fails. Its simple design—a needle that points north—has never changed in its basic idea. It works without batteries or signals. That is why it remains one of the most reliable tools ever invented.

[5] From ancient China to modern ships, the compass shows how a simple idea can change history. It helped humans explore the unknown, build trade routes, and understand our world better. The next time you hold a compass in your hand, remember that you are holding a piece of history that guided millions of people toward new horizons.

选项

A. But in the 11th century, Chinese inventors created something much more useful. B. They improved the design step by step until it became what we know today. C. It soon became an important tool for European exploration and travel. D. Sometimes phones lose signal, and GPS can be wrong in bad weather. E. All in all, the compass is a perfect example of human creativity and progress. F. Ships could now sail in any weather, and long-distance travel became safer.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：问题与发明转折。空前描述"Before the compass...sailors had to depend on sun and stars...When the sky was cloudy, they could easily get lost"，指出现代指南针发明前的困难。A选项"But in the 11th century, Chinese inventors created something much more useful"（但在11世纪，中国发明家创造了更有用的东西）中"But"承接困难，"something much more useful"自然引出空后"The compass changed all that...It uses a needle that always points north"，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：指南针的演进过程。空前详述"早期用天然磁石勺形...Over time, they learned to make a thin needle...rubbed with lodestone...lighter, easier to carry, more accurate"。B选项"They improved the design step by step until it became what we know today"（他们一步一步改进设计，直到变成我们今天所知的样子）与空前"Over time...learned to make"及"lighter...easier...accurate"形成因果，概括演进过程，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：指南针传入欧洲后的作用。空前描述"The compass spread...Arab traders brought it to the West...By the 1200s, European sailors had started to use..."，空后详述"It helped them sail farther...discovery of new lands...connected different parts of the world"。C选项"It soon became an important tool for European exploration and travel"（它很快成为欧洲探索与航行的重要工具）中"It"指代compass，"European exploration and travel"与空后"sail farther...discovery of new lands...Americas"完美呼应，逻辑紧密。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：现代仍保留指南针的原因。空前提出"Today we have GPS and digital maps"，空后转折"Yet the compass is still used...as a backup when technology fails"。D选项"Sometimes phones lose signal, and GPS can be wrong in bad weather"（有时手机会没信号，GPS在恶劣天气可能出错）解释为何需要backup，与空后"when technology fails"精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[5] E**：

- **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后列举"From ancient China to modern ships...explore the unknown, build trade routes, understand our world better"。E选项"All in all, the compass is a perfect example of human creativity and progress"（总之，指南针是人类创造力与进步的最佳例证）用"All in all"总结全文，"human creativity and progress"与空后"simple idea can change history"呼应，收束得当。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. Ships could now sail in any weather, and long-distance travel became safer.**：描述指南针带来的航海改善，与主题相关，易被误填[1]或[3]。但空[1]后段首已写"The compass changed all that"，空前需"问题/转折"引出，A的"created something useful"更贴切；空[3]空前讲"Arab traders brought it...By the 1200s, European sailors had started to use"，空后讲"sail farther...discovery of new lands"，C的"important tool for European exploration"与空后内容更契合。F属"主题相关但位置错位"型干扰，缺少与空位前后文的逻辑衔接词。